

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The 1971 Census baseline and the decisive asymmetry

ATTRIBUTED BASELINE -> THE 1971 CENSUS (never 1951, never current data)
over 400 tribal communities | nearly 38 million people | nearly 6.9 per cent of India
CONCENTRATIONS -> Madhya Pradesh | Bihar | Orissa | north-eastern India | West Bengal
-> Maharashtra | Gujarat | Rajasthan

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NORTH-EAST	EVERYWHERE ELSE	
overwhelming local majority	minorities in their own home states	
self-government is possible	only protective regulation is available	
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WHY IT MATTERS -> this asymmetry, not sentiment, dictates which Schedule applies
MUST REMEMBER: The Fifth and Sixth Schedules, community-sensitive development, the Naga settlement and statehood process, and the 1986 Mizo Accord represent different constitutional and negotiated routes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Colonial dispossession and the revolt tradition

1 MARKET PENETRATION -> money-lenders, traders, revenue farmers, middlemen, petty officials

2 DEBT AND LAND LOSS -> families engulfed in debt -> land passes to outsiders
-> reduced to agricultural labourers, sharecroppers, rack-rented tenants
-> belated anti-alienation legislation FAILS to halt the process

3 FOREST LAW -> large tracts regulated for conservation and commercial exploitation
-> shifting cultivation forbidden; access to forest produce restricted

4 OFFICIAL EXTORTION -> police, forest officials and other government officers

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REVOLT TRADITION -> Santhal uprising | Munda rebellion led by Birsa Munda

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PARTICIPATION -> national and peasant movements in Orissa, Bihar, West Bengal, Andhra,
Maharashtra and Gujarat

THIS IS THE HARM -> the post-1947 protective machinery is a reply to these four causes

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Two options rejected, one policy adopted

INFLUENCES -> VERRIER ELWIN (lived among tribal people; "formative influence" on policy)
-> JAWAHARLAL NEHRU ("the main influence in shaping the government's attitude")

OPTION A: LEAVE THEM ALONE

defect 1 -> treated "as museum specimens to be observed and written about" = "to insult them"
defect 2 -> impossible anyway; penetration by the outside world had gone too far

OPTION B: ASSIMILATE THEM QUICKLY

defect 1 -> "engulfed by the masses of Indian humanity" -> loss of social and cultural identity
defect 2 -> unscrupulous outsiders would take possession of tribal lands and forests

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ADOPTED -> INTEGRATION WITH A PRESERVED DISTINCT IDENTITY

FRAMING -> India must signify "not only a protecting force but a liberating one"

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The two parameters as a marking scheme

PARAMETER 1	PARAMETER 2
"the tribal areas have to progress"	"they have to progress in their own way"
rules out museum isolation	rules out forced assimilation
tests DEVELOPMENT DELIVERY	tests IDENTITY PRESERVATION

QUALIFIER 1 -> progress is not "merely to duplicate what we have got in other parts of India"

QUALIFIER 2 -> whatever changes are needed are "worked out by the tribals themselves"

USE IT -> political accommodation satisfies parameter 2; developmental failure breaks parameter 1

=> the honest verdict on this topic is a SPLIT verdict, and this panel is why

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The five guidelines and the label caution

FIVE BROAD GUIDELINES -> later labelled "Tribal Panchsheel" (a LABEL, not a dated decree)

- 1 OWN GENIUS -> develop along their own lines; no imposition, no compulsion
 -> non-tribals to hold no superiority complex; an EQUAL contribution
 - 2 LAND AND FOREST -> tribal rights respected; no outsider to take possession of tribal land
 -> market incursion strictly controlled and regulated
 - 3 LANGUAGES -> "all possible support"; conditions for flourishing safeguarded
 - 4 TRIBAL PERSONNEL -> administrators recruited and trained from among tribal people
 -> as few outsiders as possible, and those carefully chosen
 - 5 NO OVER-ADMIN -> develop through their own social and cultural institutions
- ROOTS -> nationalist constructive work from the 1920s; Gandhi's ashrams in tribal areas
 -> supported after independence by Rajendra Prasad, first President of India
- CAUTION -> do NOT attach an exact proclamation year to the label

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Article 46 and the four-part protective machinery

- A DIRECTIVE -> ARTICLE 46: promote with special care the educational and economic interests of the tribal people; protect from social injustice and all forms of exploitation
 - B GUBERNATORIAL -> special responsibility of Governors of states containing tribal areas
 - > power to MODIFY central and state laws in their application there
 - > power to frame regulations on land rights and against money-lenders
 - C POLITICAL -> full political rights extended
 - > reserved seats in the legislatures and reserved posts in the services
 - D ADVISORY AND INVESTIGATIVE
 - > TRIBAL ADVISORY COUNCILS in all states containing tribal areas
 - > COMMISSIONER FOR SCHEDULED CASTES AND SCHEDULED TRIBES, appointed by the President, to investigate whether the safeguards were being observed
- NOTE -> component D is what later DOCUMENTS the failure of components A to C

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Fifth Schedule and Sixth Schedule: a design matrix

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SITUATION: LOCALLY DOMINANT	SITUATION: DISPERSED MINORITY
tribal areas of Assam / North-East	other Scheduled Areas
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INSTRUMENT: SIXTH SCHEDULE	INSTRUMENT: FIFTH SCHEDULE + machinery
autonomous districts	Tribal Advisory Councils
district and regional councils	Article 46 directive
some legislative and judicial	reserved seats and services
functions, within the overall	Commissioner for Scheduled Castes and
jurisdiction of the legislature	Scheduled Tribes
and Parliament	
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STATED OBJECTIVE -> enable tribal people "to live according to their own ways"

OFFER -> the Government of India was willing to amend the provisions to widen autonomy

BOUND -> but never secession, never independence, never tolerated violence

RULE -> the two Schedules are NEVER interchangeable; details belong to the Polity owner

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Where the policy failed: execution, not design

FAILURES

- 1 weak execution of well-intentioned measures
- 2 divergence between central and state policy
- 3 Tribal Advisory Councils ineffective
- 4 funds unspent, unproductive or misappropriated
- 5 anti-alienation laws evaded -> land loss
- 6 mines, industries and deforestation displace and dispossess
- 7 a small tribal elite captures the gains

GAINS

- | literacy and education spread
- | reservations in services and higher education
- | Panchayati Raj and repeated elections
- | rising political participation and representation
- | demands for a greater share in national economic development

OUTSIDE THE NORTH-EAST -> tribal people remained poor, indebted, landless, often unemployed

SPLIT VERDICT -> POLITICAL ACCOMMODATION SUCCEEDED | DEVELOPMENTAL DELIVERY DID NOT

ATTRIBUTION -> the failure is attributed to implementation and neglect, not to the design

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Why the North-East differed, and the NEFA control case

REASON 1 DEMOGRAPHY -> over a hundred groups; overwhelming local majority
-> non-tribals had not penetrated to any significant extent

REASON 2 COLONIAL ADMINISTRATION -> separate administrative status inside Assam province
-> socio-political structure undisturbed; plainsmen barred from buying land
-> LITTLE LOSS OF LAND; missionaries permitted: schools, hospitals, churches

REASON 3 DETACHMENT -> "virtual absence of any political or cultural contact" with Indian
political life; the anti-imperialist bond had little purchase here
-> some missionaries and foreigners promoted separatist sentiment after 1947

CONTROL CASE -> NEFA created 1948 out of the border areas of Assam
-> a Union Territory OUTSIDE Assam's jurisdiction, special cadre of officers
-> develop WITHOUT disturbing social and cultural patterns of life
-> Nehru's and Elwin's policies "implemented best of all" here
-> RENAMED ARUNACHAL PRADESH 1972; STATEHOOD 1987

OCR CAVEAT -> the local book compresses naming and statehood into one 1987 sentence

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: The Naga two-track template, 1955 to 1963

1955 -> Phizo-led separatists declare an "independent government"; violent insurrection

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+--- TRACK 1: REFUSE -----+--- TRACK 2: OFFER -----+

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secession firmly opposed

| a large degree of autonomy

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no negotiation while independence

| prolonged negotiation with moderate, |

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and arms are retained

| non-violent, non-secessionist leaders|

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EARLY 1956 -> army sent to restore

| conciliation is the stated objective |

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peace and order

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MID-1957 -> the back of the armed rebellion is broken

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MODERATES -> Dr Imkongliba Ao and others come forward and negotiate for a state in the union

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1963 -> THE STATE OF NAGALAND COMES INTO EXISTENCE (within the Union, never independence)

AFTER -> politics in Nagaland follows the pattern of other states of the union

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Nehru's tribal policy rejected both forced assimilation and museum-like isolation, but administrative practice, land alienation, forests, displacement and autonomy remained contested.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: A language trigger becomes the reorganisation of 1972

GRIEVANCE -> hill tribes have no cultural affinity with Assamese and Bengali plainsmen
-> fear of "Assamization"; resentment at the attitudes of non-tribal officials

1960 -> Assamese leaders move to make Assamese the SOLE official language of the state

1960 -> hill parties merge into the ALL PARTY HILL LEADERS CONFERENCE; separate state demanded
-> the Assam Official Language Act triggers hartals, demonstrations, a major agitation

1962 -> separate-state advocates sweep the tribal-area Assembly seats and boycott the Assembly

1969 -> constitutional amendment: MEGHALAYA as "a state within a state"
-> complete autonomy EXCEPT law and order; shared High Court, Public Service Commission, Governor

1972 -> REORGANISATION OF THE NORTH-EAST
MEGHALAYA becomes a separate state (Garo, Khasi and Jaintia tribes)
MANIPUR and TRIPURA are simultaneously granted statehood
NEFA is renamed ARUNACHAL PRADESH (statehood follows in 1987)

BRIDGE -> this is where language politics and tribal politics meet directly

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Constitutional text, Verrier Elwin's influence, movement records and tribal voices must be compared; integration is a negotiated process, not proof of cultural absorption or completed equality.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Mizoram and Jharkhand: two endings, two lessons

MIZORAM -> the accommodation model, over twenty-one years

1959 famine relief failure | 1961 Assamese made the state's official language -> grievance

MIZO NATIONAL FRONT formed, LALDenga president; elections contested, military wing built

MAR 1966 independence declared, military uprising, attacks -> crushed within a few weeks

1973 demand scaled down to a state within the union -> MIZORAM constituted a UNION TERRITORY

1986 ACCORD -> arms surrendered, underground activity abandoned, full statehood granted

FEB 1987 LALDenga SWORN IN AS CHIEF MINISTER

CAUTION -> the model case, NOT the universal outcome; no current security claim belongs here

JHARKHAND -> the demography model, an identity claim that outgrew its own base

1950 JHARKHAND PARTY founded by JAIPAL SINGH | 1952 32 SEATS, main opposition in Bihar

1957 25 seats | 1962 20 seats -> electoral decline

Scheduled Tribes: Chota Nagpur 31.15% (1951) -> 30.94% (1971)

Santhal Parganas 44.67% (1951) -> 36.22% (1971)

=> nearly TWO-THIRDS of the region non-tribal in 1971

1955 SRC refuses a Jharkhand state: "the region did not have a common language"

1963 Jaipal Singh and much of the leadership join the Congress

1972 JHARKHAND MUKTI MORCHA formed; SHIBU SOREN emerges; demand recast as REGIONAL

LIMIT -> the shift was never complete; the movement stayed built on tribal identity